

Decory Edwards
Johns Hopkins University
Department of Economics

December 26, 2025

Hiring Committee
The Muse

Dear Hiring Committee,

I am writing to apply for the Junior Business Analyst position at The Muse. I am currently a PhD candidate in Economics at Johns Hopkins University. My training combines structured analytical reasoning, data driven analysis, and clear communication. I am motivated by work that requires translating ambiguous questions into well defined problems and delivering insights that support better decisions. The Muse's mission of helping people navigate careers through trusted guidance aligns closely with my interests and analytical approach.

My research agenda is at the intersection of wealth inequality and macroeconomics. In my job market paper, I build and estimate a structural heterogeneous agent model with returns that differ across households. The core contribution is to show how heterogeneity in returns and income risk jointly shape the wealth distribution and consumption behavior. Relative to closely related work, my framework performs better at matching the lower and middle portions of the wealth distribution. This difference matters quantitatively. Models that focus primarily on returns heterogeneity can fit the top of the wealth distribution closely but tend to generate too much wealth among the bottom half of households. In my framework, income uncertainty generates a precautionary saving motive that produces genuinely low wealth households. This leads to a realistic distribution of marginal propensities to consume and aggregate consumption responses that align with empirical estimates.

A key feature of my research is working closely with stakeholders to clarify objectives, structure analysis, and deliver actionable insights. I regularly gather requirements, analyze processes, and synthesize findings into clear written documentation. I enjoy identifying opportunities for improvement and supporting implementation through careful analysis and communication. This work mirrors the core responsibilities of a business analyst.

I am particularly interested in The Muse because of its collaborative culture and its focus on data informed decision making across diverse industries. The opportunity to work remotely while contributing to projects that improve how organizations align business goals with technical capabilities is especially appealing. I value environments that encourage independence while supporting learning and growth.

My economics training has provided a strong foundation in analytical problem solving, organization, and communication. I am detail oriented, comfortable working independently, and proactive in managing tasks and deadlines. I take pride in producing clear documentation and in collaborating effectively with cross functional teams.

I would welcome the opportunity to contribute my skills and perspective to The Muse. Thank you

for your time and consideration.

Sincerely,

Decory Edwards